

Nick Shaw

Head of QA and Delivery – SaaS | Enterprise | Public Sector

Belfast, UK | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Head of QA and Delivery with 12 years' experience leading high-performing teams and directing large-scale software delivery across SaaS, enterprise, public sector and healthcare environments. I have built and scaled teams of up to 25 engineers, architected Playwright automation frameworks and delivered multiple concurrent programmes that improved test coverage, accelerated release cadence and reduced production defects.

I bring cross-functional leadership experience across QA, delivery and product management, including Product Owner, Scrum Master and project oversight responsibilities. My focus is on strategic governance, risk-aware delivery, Agile transformation and embedding automation and AI-assisted testing to drive efficiency and consistent quality outcomes. I work closely with senior executives to optimise organisational performance and ensure delivery excellence across complex regulated programmes.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- QA Strategy, Governance and Test Lifecycle Leadership
- Test Automation and Quality Engineering (Playwright, BDD, AI-assisted testing)
- Multi-Team Leadership, Resourcing and Delivery Management
- Agile Delivery and Product Leadership (Scrum Master, Product Owner)
- Risk-Based Testing, Defect Management and Regulatory Compliance
- Accessibility Compliance (WCAG 2.1) and Inclusive Design
- Performance, API, Integration and Data Validation
- UAT, Release Management and Go-Live Governance
- Executive and Stakeholder Engagement, C-Suite Reporting
- Public Sector Bid and Tender Support

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of QA (Promoted from Lead QA)

Cloudbooking | London, UK (Remote) | March 2025 – December 2025

Directed QA strategy, delivery operations and performance across a 17-person SaaS team spanning web, mobile and tablet platforms.

Key Achievements

- Doubled test coverage from 45% to 90% within six months through structured test case development, embedding QA in backlog refinement and implementing shift-left testing practices
- Reduced manual regression effort by 40%, enhancing pre-release confidence and release stability
- Improved release cadence from monthly to twice-monthly through enhanced delivery governance and sprint structures

- Led delivery and QA operations across multiple product streams, coordinating releases, cross-team collaboration and operational governance
- Directed team resourcing, hiring, onboarding and performance management
- Member of the senior management team, collaborating with the C-suite on product and programme strategy
- Oversaw end-to-end test lifecycle and release readiness across .NET, MAUI and React SaaS platforms
- Architected a Playwright automation framework (JavaScript) for critical end-to-end workflows, establishing scalable automated regression capability
- Implemented accessibility-first delivery (WCAG 2.1), embedding standards into sprint execution
- Acted as Product Owner and Scrum Master, managing SaaS roadmap and leading sprint planning, execution and dependency control

Tools: Axe DevTools, Azure DevOps, Google Lighthouse, Jira, Miro, NVDA, OWASP ZAP, Playwright (JavaScript), Postman, Qase, SQL, Swagger, TestRail, WAV

Test Manager

ITS Computing Ltd | Belfast, UK (Remote) | June 2021 – December 2024

Led QA and delivery across a 25-person, distributed team spanning the UK and India, owning QA strategy, delivery governance and test lifecycle execution for major national public sector programmes within complex regulatory environments.

Key Achievements

- Built and scaled test automation capability from scratch, implementing Playwright and TestComplete while increasing regression coverage across programmes
- Standardised QA processes, governance frameworks and documentation, improving delivery consistency and quality across all projects
- Delivered end-to-end QA strategy and full test lifecycle for national programmes, including LPS Rates and Benefits, Insolvency Service GB, NISRA, PBNi and FSNI
- Led delivery and QA operations across concurrent Agile and Waterfall projects, coordinating cross-team activities, release governance and programme delivery
- Managed a 25-person UK and India testing team, directing resourcing, hiring, mentoring, vendor relationships and performance management
- Implemented accessibility-first practices (WCAG 2.1), embedding accessibility standards and delivering team training
- Oversaw performance testing using JMeter to validate scalability and regulatory compliance
- Acted as Product Owner and Scrum Master, managing backlog, sprint execution and cross-team delivery alignment
- Managed UAT, change control and pre-release validation to ensure compliant, production-ready delivery

Tools: Axe DevTools, Azure DevOps, JMeter, Jira, Miro, NVDA, Playwright (JavaScript), Postman, SQL, Swagger, TestComplete, WAV

EARLIER CAREER

Senior QA Engineer

HHA Exchange | Belfast, UK (Remote) | March 2019 – June 2021

- Contributed to QA delivery on a large-scale US healthcare SaaS platform (.NET, Angular), supporting distributed teams in a regulated environment
- Maintained BDD automation suites (SpecFlow/Gherkin) and conducted API, integration and end-to-end testing across Agile delivery cycles

QA Engineer

Flowlens | Belfast, UK | September 2017 – March 2019

- Conducted functional and integration testing across multiple SaaS modules (Ruby on Rails), including integrations with Xero and QuickBooks
- Produced test documentation and onboarding materials to improve knowledge transfer and support issue resolution

UK QA Lead

Concentrix | Belfast, UK (Remote) | November 2013 – November 2016

- Managed a 10-person QA team for .NET CRM SaaS platforms, supporting enterprise clients including Riverbed, Polycom, Symantec and Acronis
- Oversaw end-to-end QA strategy, SDLC governance and defect management, including on-site project delivery and stakeholder collaboration in Boston, New York and San Francisco
- Delivered functional, regression, integration and UAT testing, ensuring global QA consistency through training and documentation rollouts
- Promoted internally from Intern to Junior QA, Senior QA and UK QA Lead

QUALIFICATIONS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Claude 101 (Anthropic), 2026
- Claude Code in Action (Anthropic), 2026
- Introduction to Agent Skills (Anthropic), 2026
- Certified Scrum Master (CSM), 2025
- Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), 2025
- ISTQB Foundation Certificate, 2013

EDUCATION

Queen's University, Belfast

- MA Creative Writing, Merit (2012–2013)
- BA (Hons) English, 2:1 (2007–2010)

ADDITIONAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Selected for the BBC Voices Scriptwriting Programme (2026), a highly competitive national scheme for emerging writers
- Authored sketches and plays performed at Grand Opera House, Lyric Theatre and MAC Theatre; commissioned by Tinderbox Theatre Company